



THE EARLY FARMERS

About 12,000 years ago, there was an important change in the way people lived. People in parts of western Asia began to settle in one place and farm the land. They learned how to grow crops for food, and how to tame wild animals so they had a regular supply of meat. This new way of life was so successful that it soon spread far and wide.

As the people no longer moved around, they built houses to live in. They learned to spin and weave cloth and also to make pottery.

Bringing in the harvest

When the crop was ripe, it was cut down with a sickle. This was made of a sharp flint blade set in a wooden handle.



Bullock



Goat



Sheep

Taming animals

Young wild animals were caught by hunters and raised on the farms so they became used to being around people.

First crops

This is emmer wheat. Emmer was developed from the seeds of wild grasses to become an important food source.

